

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	SEWAGE WASTE - COLLECTION OF	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group - Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025 SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> 	 Signature
			<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L <i>Likely</i>	M <i>Moderate</i>	U <i>Unlikely</i>
H (1) <i>(High level of harm)</i>	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) <i>(High)</i>	1	1	2
M (2) <i>(Medium level of harm)</i>	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) <i>(Medium)</i>	1	2	3
L (3) <i>(Low level of harm)</i>	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) <i>(Low)</i>	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Training and skill.	Un-trained persons could cause injury or infection to themselves and others.	1	1. All persons working on site must carry with them a current 'Construction Induction Card'. 2. All persons working on site must be suitably trained and competent in the task they are to perform. 3. Workers are to be adequately supervised.	Supervisor and Workers	2
Personal Protective Clothing & Equipment (PPE)	Bodily injuries Spills and splashes onto workers' eyes / skin	1	1. Before starting work on site check available PPE is adequate for all tasks to be undertaken and in good working condition including; safety boots, safety glasses, ear muffs and other protective clothing & equipment as required.	Workers	2
Operating plant.	Plant failure	1	1. Pre start check to be completed prior to start of works each day. 2. Plant to be properly maintained and checked before use.	Workers	2
Site Hazard Assessment	Various including serious illness.	1	1. On arrival at site complete a site hazard assessment by using this SWMS as a checklist.	Workers	2
	Trip, slip hazards.	2	1. Clear any obstacles from around work areas before work progresses. 2. Keep access ways clear of trip hazards.	Workers	3
	UV Exposure; skin cancer.	1	1. Be sun smart wear a broad brimmed hat, sun/safety glasses, sun protective clothing and 30+ sunscreen.	Workers	2
	Vehicle access Collisions with vehicles or pedestrians.	1	1. Drive only in designated access routes. 2. Do not park vehicles where it will create a hazard to public vehicles or pedestrians.	Workers	2
	Manual handling disorders.	2	1. Park vehicle as close as safely possible to area to minimize handling of hoses. 2. Physical fitness and warm up exercises will assist in avoiding manual handling injury. 3. Only carry what is a comfortable weight and do not overload yourself. Team lift if necessary. 4. Bend your knees when lifting not your back. 5. Take care when lifting septic tank lids- use the correct tool.	Workers	3
	Un-stable soils.	2	1. Be aware of un-stable soils, septic systems in areas of unstable soils or areas of commonly-found site-built systems are a collapse risk.	Workers	3

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
	Bad septic tank covers flimsy, rusted, old-steel, home-made, or missing septic tank covers Collapsed, or collapsing septic tanks.	1	1. Be aware of unsafe covers when walking around site trying to locate the septic tank and when attempting to open lid.	Workers	2
	Shock & Electrical Hazards	1	1. If having to dig an area to find the septic tank lid, watch out that you don't dig into and cut an electrical wire (or other buried mechanical line such as a gas or water line). Buried electrical wires can look a lot like tree roots. Chopping through an electrical wire while digging to find a septic system can be dangerous.	Workers	2
	Septic tank pumping or agitating to remove blockage- sudden collapse	1	1. Do not attempt to pump, aerate, or agitate cesspools in an attempt to restore function as this can lead to sudden collapse of these systems, especially if the cesspool or septic tank was "site built" using stacked concrete blocks or stone.	Workers	2
	Falling into a septic tank or cesspool is likely to lead to rapid asphyxiation from methane and in cases of collapse, there is risk of becoming buried.	1	1. Don't work alone: Falling into a septic tank or even leaning over a septic tank can be fatal. 2. Workers can become suddenly overcome by methane gas. 3. Do not ever enter a septic tank unless you are specially trained and are wearing the special equipment and gear for that purpose, including self-contained breathing apparatus. 4. Do not go into a septic tank to retrieve someone who has fallen in and was overcome by toxic gases unless you are equipped with a self-contained breathing apparatus (SCBA). If a SCBA is not available, call for emergency services and put one or more fans at the top of the septic tank to blow in fresh air. 5. Do not lean over or stick your head into the septic tank to examine its interior - you could fall into the tank or become overcome by gases and fall into the tank, an event which is likely to be fatal.	Workers	2
	Unsanitary conditions- bacterial hazards	1	1. Be alert for unsanitary conditions such as surface effluent or sewage backups into buildings, events which risk serious viral and bacterial hazards and that are indoors, may require professional cleaning.	Workers	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			2. Be alert for personal sanitation hazards when working around septic systems, such as open cuts or failure to wash properly after working on systems.		
	Explosion	1	1. Don't ignite flames -Do not light a flame or smoke at or near the tank - methane gas is explosive.	Workers	2
	Flooded septic system	1	1. When the Septic System is Flooded Don't Pump It Out. If the property has been flooded by rising water such as from a storm, or a river overflow, pumping out a septic tank when ground waters are still flooding the area of the septic tank can lead to some unexpected problems: If the septic tank is plastic or fiberglass, and if ground water is still high around the septic tank, the tank may actually float up out of the ground, leading to damaged septic piping and more costly repairs. Wait until floodwaters and ground waters have receded around the septic tank. 2. Even if the septic tank is concrete, if ground water is over the septic tank or even over its inlet piping or drainfield piping, if you pump out the flooded septic tank, floodwaters, including silt and mud may simply flow into the tank, filling it with silt and debris that will need to be removed. Wait until floodwaters have receded and ground water is low enough that mud and silt and floodwater won't simply run back into the tank.	Workers	2
	Old or site built septic tanks – risk of collapse	1	1. If Inspecting an old, site-built septic system built of dry-laid stone or concrete block, and in particular an old home-made septic tank it is at high risk of collapsing when it is pumped or collapsing shortly thereafter. In an "unknown construction" condition, you might not even know if what's installed is a conventional septic tank. In such cases proceed with caution, perhaps pumping from high in the "tank" only a portion of its contents, just sufficient to inspect (flashlight and mirror on a pole) the tank interior to see how it was constructed and what is its condition. 2. Before completing any septic pump-out or other septic repair work, be sure you have safe covers	Workers	2
	Fall injury	2	1. Workers to use 3 points of contact when climbing up and down from vehicles.	Workers	3

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			2. Ensure good footing when climbing up and down stairs to separator pits.		
	Low overhead wires-electrocution	1	Operators need to keep vehicles/equipment- hoses. 1. At least 3 metres from 132,000 volt lines. 2. At least 6 metres from 132,000 to 330,000volt lines. 3. Areas closer than 3m are no go zone. 4. Use certified spotter if working near powerlines. (3m to 6.4m) 5. Clarify safe working distances with site manager. 6. If in doubt of line voltage keep at least 8 metres away.	Workers	2
	Snakes	1	1. Snake bite bandages carried in first aid kit. All workers trained in correct use of bandage if bitten.	Workers	2
	Inclement weather	3	1. Workers to wear appropriate wet weather gear.	Workers	3
	Needle stick injury	1	1. Sewer pipe blockages could be due to discarded syringes 2. Needle collection kits to be available in each vehicle. 3. Workers to be careful not to put their hands into any liquid waste incase of discarded needles present.	Management Workers	2
	Exposure to noise	2	1. Suppress noise using mufflers if required. 2. Hearing protection must be worn at appropriate times when working near noisy equipment or where equipment is suitably signed.	Management Workers	3
Personal Hygiene Considerations	Serious illness even death	1	Septic waste may be inadvertently ingested or absorbed through the skin due to improper personal hygiene practices. To minimize the possibility of this occurring: 1. Do not eat, drink or smoke in the work area. 2. Always wash hands (minimum) and face before eating, drinking or smoking. 3. Wear protective coveralls over street clothes or specially laundered industrial garments in work areas and remove these before leaving. Garments heavily soiled or soaked with hydrocarbon should not be worn but should be exchanged or discarded for clean garments. 4. Shower thoroughly after completion of work. 5. Avoid handling foam ear hearing protectors with unwashed hands.	Workers	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			6. Immunizations such as tetanus must be kept up to date. Basic primary series of 3 doses - Booster every 10 years and Hepatitis injections.		
Before leaving site	Trip hazards etc Unauthorised entry	2	1. Ensure site is clean upon leaving 2. Close gates etc on departure.	Workers	3
Proceed to effluent disposal site	Environmental hazard	1	1. Ensure effluent is taken to treatment works or appropriate refuse facility.	Workers	2
Truck wash out procedure	Fall from height	1	1. Wear the risk of fall is > 2 metres, workers are to use a harness clipped to rail on truck when cleaning/ washing out after use. 2. Dispose of wash out liquid at treatment plant in accordance with vacuum loading training. Follow all site procedures, disposal area instructions and all safety signs. 3. Conduct a 360 degree walk around prior to leaving site and ensure all tank doors are isolated and closed with safety catches in place.	Workers	2

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste products will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment

All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:

Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.

All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card					
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management		
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training	Fire Extinguisher training	Fatigue Management Training		

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)

Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022

Codes of Practice

Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity

Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.